

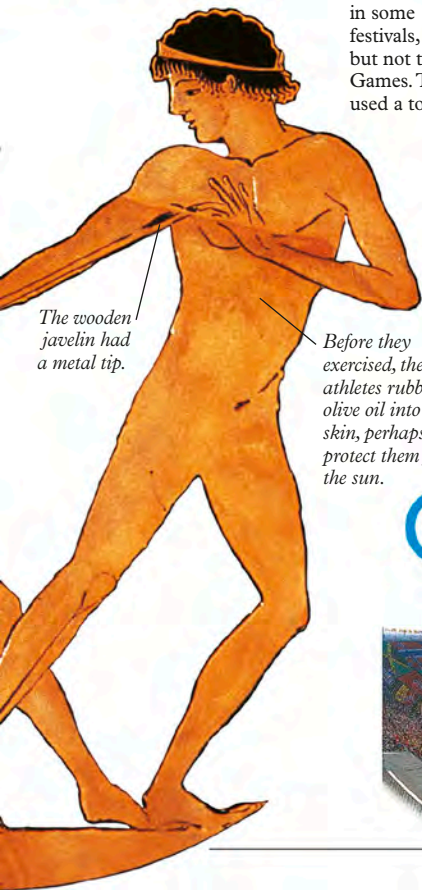


The pentathlon

The decoration on this vase shows athletes training for the pentathlon. The contest included wrestling, throwing the javelin and discus, running, and the long jump.

Handing over

Relay races were included in some festivals, but not the Olympic Games. The runners used a torch as a baton.

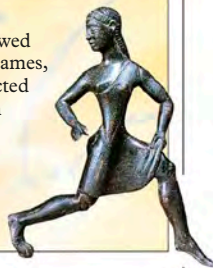


The wooden javelin had a metal tip.

Before they exercised, the athletes rubbed olive oil into their skin, perhaps to protect them from the sun.

Equal opportunities

Only men and boys were allowed to compete in the Olympic Games, but in Sparta girls were expected to go through the same tough athletic training as the boys. This little bronze statue of a girl runner from Sparta shows her barefoot and wearing a short tunic.



Inspiration from the past

The idea for today's Olympics came from the Ancient Greek games of more than 2,000 years ago. The interlocking Olympic rings represent the five competing continents.

